

Tanks of the NATO Alliance (cont.)

NATO nations standardized many aspects of their militaries so that they could fight effectively together, including ammunition, fuel, and command procedures. However, despite several failed multinational projects, the alliance never produced a NATO standard tank. From the late 1950s, however, the British-designed L7 105 mm gun was widely—although not exclusively—adopted for use in tanks across the nations of the alliance.

▷ **AMX-30B2**

Date	1963	Country	France
Weight	40.8 tons (37 tonnes)		
Engine	Hispano-Suiza HS110 multifuel, 720 hp		
Main armament	105 mm Model F1 L/56 rifled gun		

The lightweight AMX-30 was the result of French tank design in the 1950s, emphasizing mobility and firepower. The tank's low height and speed of up to 40mph (64km/h) provided extra protection. After serving the French Army throughout the Cold War, the upgraded AMX-30B2 saw combat in the Gulf War of 1991.

105 mm main gun



▷ **Leopard 1**

Date	1965	Country	West Germany
Weight	46.7 tons (42.4 tonnes)		
Engine	MTU MB838 multifuel, 830 hp		
Main armament	105 mm L7A3 L/52 gun		

Unlike Germany's wartime tanks, the Leopard was fast with thin armor. Around 5,000 of these were produced and they served over a dozen nations. In more than 30 years of service, it received upgrades in armor protection, sights, and fire control system. Two turret variants were produced—this one was cast, the other, with an angular shape, was welded.



△ **Centurion Mark 13**

Date	1966	Country	UK
Weight	58 tons (52.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce Meteor Mark IVB gasoline, 650 hp		
Main armament	105 mm L7 L/52 rifled gun		

The 105mm L7 gun was developed after the British analyzed the Soviet T-54 tank. It was attached to the Centurion in 1959. Subsequent Centurions were equipped with ranging machine guns for accurate gunnery, an infrared searchlight for night fighting, and thicker armor. Upgraded Israeli versions of the Centurion saw heavy combat and earned a stellar reputation.

▽ **M60A2**

Date	1972	Country	USA
Weight	58 tons (52.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Continental AVOS-1790-2A diesel, 750 hp		
Main armament	152 mm M162 gun/missile launcher		

The M60A2 had a radically redesigned turret armed with a 152 mm gun that could also fire the MGM-51 Shillelagh anti-tank missile. Unsuccessful, it was withdrawn in 1980. Instead, the M60A3 was developed, which kept the 105 mm gun and added a laser rangefinder, sophisticated fire-control system, and a thermal sight often rated better than that on early M1 Abrams.

